

In the past decade, the culinary world has experienced a seismic shift with the rise of gourmet festivals, redefining how we celebrate and appreciate food. Gone are the days when food festivals were modest, local affairs organised as community events. Today, gourmet festivals are grand global events held annually in glamorous locations, attracting the crème de la crème of the culinary world.

These festivals are meticulously curated events showcasing high-end gastronomy. Typically lasting a week, they feature star-studded line-ups of world-famous chefs like Massimo Bottura, René Redzepi, and Alain Passard. They involve masterclasses, wine tastings, panel discussions, exhibitions, documentary screenings, foraging trips, after-parties, and of course delicious food. Held in stunning locations such as St Moritz, Rovinj, Udine, Cairo, Brunico, and Tulum, gourmet festivals attract sophisticated foodies seeking unique experiences and bragging rights. Interestingly, it's often easier and more affordable for culinary enthusiasts to enjoy their favourite chefs' creations at these events, as they are subsidised by sponsors, eliminating the need to secure reservations at Michelin-starred restaurants.

Want to mingle with the culinary elite at a top gourmet festival? Here are three you should have on your radar:

CARE'S

LOCATION: Brunico, Italy

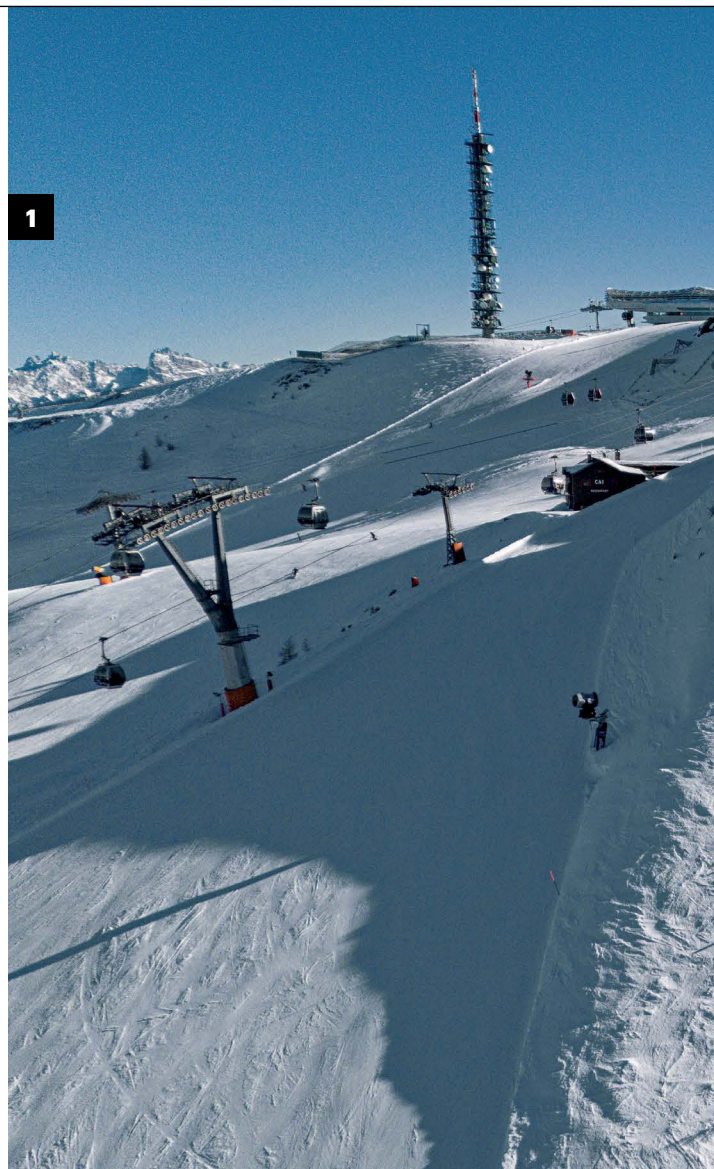
TICKETS: Can be purchased online on care-s.it

COST: €100-250 for individual dinners

MONTH: February-March

USP: Haute cuisine on the ski slopes of the Dolomite Alps

The CARE's festival is a paradise for ski enthusiasts, set amidst the breathtaking Dolomite Alps in the charming tourist town of Brunico, on the border of Italy and Austria. The journey to the festival is a scenic drive through limestone peaks and picturesque valleys surrounding this UNESCO World Heritage



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HAUTE ON THE ICE The Lumen Museum in Kronplatz, Italy, where the CARE's festival is held every year

Site. Founded a decade ago by Norbert Niederkofler, the region's most famous chef and owner of the three Michelin-starred Atelier Moessmer, the festival was envisioned to promote ethical and sustainable approaches to food.

Originally exclusive to chefs, CARE's now attracts food lovers worldwide, who book stays in the region's converted castles and boutique hotels. The opening event kicks off with a thrilling ski-lift ride to the Lumen Museum in Kronplatz, 2,275 metres above sea level, and home to Niederkofler's AlpiNN Food Space, which is possibly the world's highest restaurant. While attendees are encouraged to